

Section	Description
Use case name	States the use case name. Typically, the name expresses the objective or observable result of the use case, such as “Withdraw Cash” in the case of an automatic teller machine.
Brief description	Describes the role and purpose of the use case.
Flow of events	Presents the basic flow and alternative flows. The flow of events describes the behavior of the system; it does not describe how the system works, the details of the presentation, or the details of the user interface. If information is exchanged, the use case must be specific about what is passed back and forth. For example, instead of describing an action as “the actor enters customer information”, indicate that “the actor enters the customer name and address.”
Basic flow	Describes the ideal, primary behavior of the system.
Alternative flows	Describes exceptions or deviations from the basic flow, such as how the system behaves when the actor enters an incorrect user ID and the user authentication fails.
Special requirements	Nonfunctional requirements that are specific to a use case but are not specified in the text of the use case flow of events. Examples of special requirements include these factors: legal and regulatory requirements; application standards; quality attributes of the system, including usability, reliability, performance, and supportability; operating systems and environments; compatibility requirements; and design constraints.
Preconditions	A state of the system that must be present before a use case starts.
Post conditions	A list of possible states for the system immediately after a use case is finished.
Extension points	A point in the use case flow of events at which another use case is referenced.

Example 1: ATM – Withdraw Cash

Section	Description
Use case name	Withdraw Cash
Brief description	Customer withdraws money from their bank account using the ATM.
Flow of events	Customer inserts card → enters PIN → selects “Withdraw” → enters amount → ATM dispenses cash → prints receipt.
Basic flow	Successful withdrawal with valid card, PIN, and sufficient balance.
Alternative flows	Invalid PIN entered → system rejects transaction. Insufficient funds → system displays error.
Special requirements	Must comply with banking security standards; transaction must complete within 30 seconds.
Preconditions	Customer has an active bank account and a valid ATM card.
Post conditions	Account balance updated; cash dispensed; transaction logged.
Extension points	“Check Balance” use case can be invoked before withdrawal.